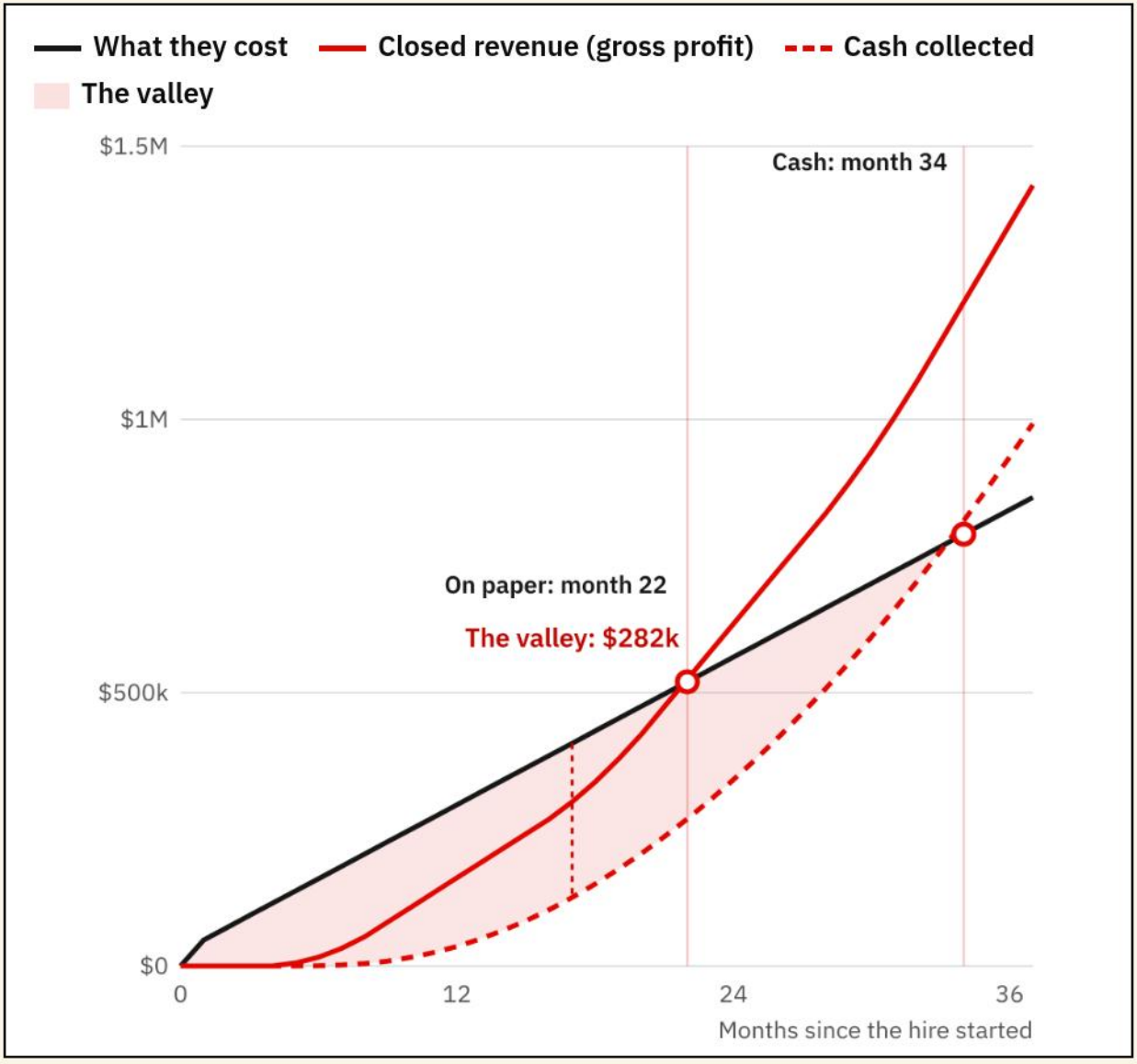
FIRST SALES HIRE

Your first sales hire digs a cash hole before they fill it.



Real chart from the Founders Ramp payback calculator, default example inputs.

THE QUESTION EVERY FOUNDER ASKS

When does my first sales hire pay for itself?

Most founders answer with a gut feel. There are really two answers, and they can be a year apart.

On paper

When the gross profit on deals they've closed passes what they cost.

In the bank

When the cash you've collected passes what they cost.

The gap between them is the valley.

The cash you're out while you wait. Run out of runway there and the hire never gets to pay back.

WHAT THE CALCULATOR SHOWS

Two dates and the size of the valley.

Put in pay, ramp time, sales cycle and deal size. You get a straight answer, like this one:



Screenshot of the live calculator, default example inputs.

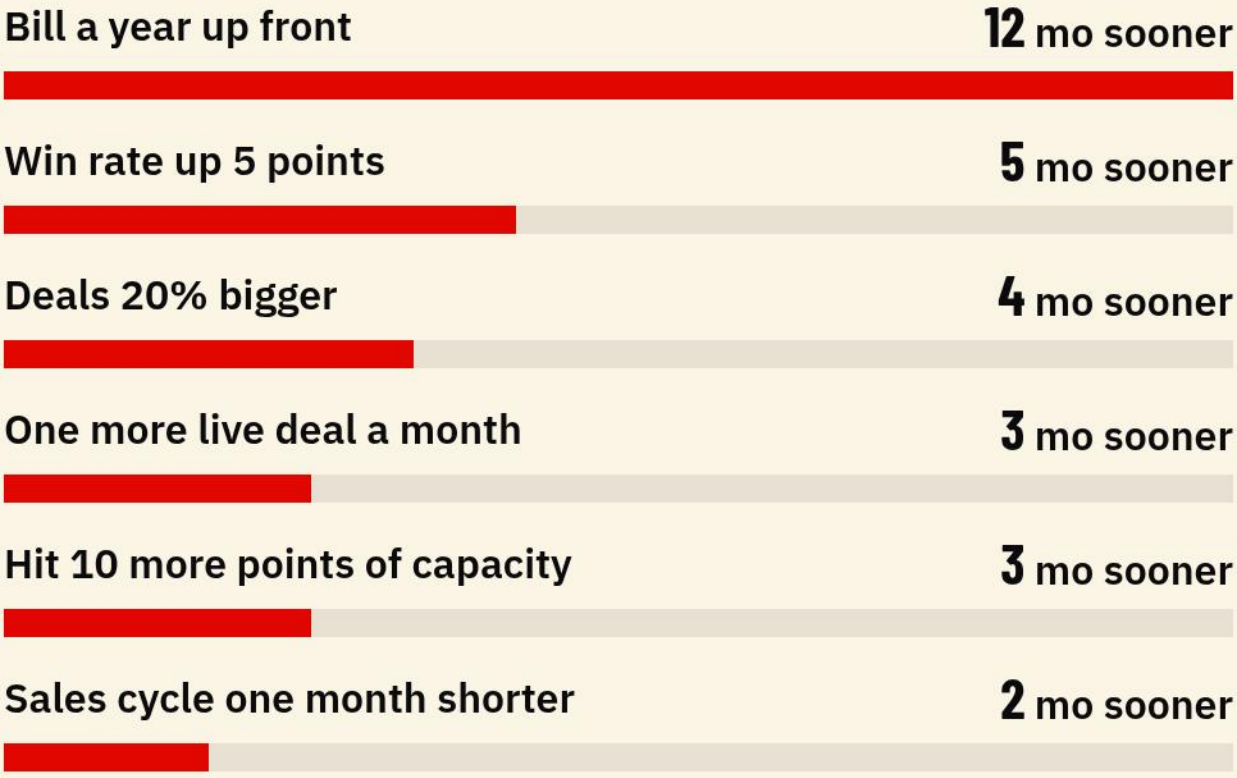
> **"At the low point, in month 17, you're out $282,060 in cash."**
>
> What the calculator says next, same example.

The valley is the most cash you're out before the hire pays back. Plan your runway around it.

THEN IT SHOWS WHAT MOVES THE DATE

The biggest lever here isn't more selling.

Months saved on cash payback. Each bar changes one thing and keeps the rest the same.



From the live calculator, same default example. Your numbers will move these.

FREE TOOL

Run your numbers before you hire.

See your paper payback, your cash payback and your valley.

FIRST HIRE PAYBACK CALCULATOR

foundersramp.net/tools/first-hire-payback

No email needed. What you type stays in your browser. Link in the comments.